



Section 504 Parent Information Sheet

Section 504 is...

Section 504 is part of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 that is an anti-discrimination civil rights statute that requires the needs of students with disabilities to be met as adequately as the needs of the non-disabled students. This means any physical or mental condition that substantially limits a major life activity, which can include reading, learning and concentrating.

Things to know

- Determining initial eligibility for a Section 504 Plan is completed thru an evaluation process and is a team decision.
- A Section 504 Initial Evaluation team consists of persons who are knowledgeable about the student and will include: The counselor, teachers, administrator, parent(s), and student when appropriate.
- A student may be determined to be eligible for a Section 504 Plan and not require accommodations at the time of eligibility. Students who fall in this category are known as Technically Eligible and all procedural rights are applicable.
- A Section 504 Plan is a plan of accommodations to ensure equal access for the student with a disability as compared to non-disabled peers.
- A Section 504 Evaluation Team may determine the student not to be eligible for a 504 Plan if the student's impairment is not identified as substantially limiting.

504 Evaluation Process

- Requests a Section 504 Evaluation to the school counselor.
- Parents provide any outside evaluations to the evaluation team if they wish for the information to be considered as part of the evaluation process.
- An initial evaluation may take up to 60 school days to complete. A variety of data is gathered for review including, but not limited to: current academic performance, current plans of intervention, parent and student input, etc.

What it is not...

- A Section 504 Plan is a plan of accommodations and does not include goals and services included within an Individualized Education Plan (IEP).
- A Section 504 Plan does not include specialized instruction related to content specific deficits, but rather is a plan of accommodations to support equal access to classroom curriculum.
- A Section 504 Plan does not ensure an increase in grades or decrease in behavior, but rather access to the general education curriculum.

Accommodations available to all students without a 504 plan...

- Preferential seating
- Teacher check-ins
- Breaking larger assignments into smaller steps
- Guided notes
- Regular breaks
- The use of a fidget

Could a different plan support my student?

A *student assistance plan* is an action plan that includes goals, interventions, and accommodations. This plan is reviewed regularly like a 504 plan.